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CODE OF ETHICS

International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc.

Edition	Revised edition (supersedes all prior versions)
Effective date	November 11, 2026
Approved by	Board of Directors of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc., Resolution No. 2026-01 dated November 11, 2026

1. Purpose of the Code of Ethics

The purpose of this Code of Ethics is to establish the core ethical principles, standards of professional conduct and behavioral expectations applicable to all members of International Beauty Professionals Association, Inc. ("IBPA" or the "Association").

This Code of Ethics is intended to:

- support the mission, values and standards of the Association;
- promote integrity, professionalism and accountability in the beauty industry;
- protect the reputation of the Association and its members;
- provide ethical guidance for members in their professional, educational, business, public and Association-related activities;
- establish a basis for evaluating ethical issues, misconduct and disciplinary matters.

This Code of Ethics applies to all membership categories, including, without limitation, Specialist, Professional, Trainer / Educator, Business Owner and Brand / Company, to the extent applicable to the nature of their role and participation.

2. Guiding Principles

All IBPA members are expected to conduct themselves in accordance with the following core principles:

2.1 Professionalism

Members must maintain a high standard of professional conduct, communication and accountability in all of their professional and Association-related activities.

2.2 Integrity

Members must act honestly, fairly and in good faith, and avoid deceptive, misleading, manipulative or unethical conduct.

2.3 Respect

Members must treat clients, colleagues, students, educators, judges, partners, employees, directors, committee members and members of the public with dignity, courtesy and respect.

2.4 Accountability

Members must take responsibility for their actions, professional statements, decisions and conduct, including conduct that may affect the Association or the professional community.

2.5 Commitment to Quality

Members must strive to maintain and improve the quality of their work, services, education, leadership and business practice.

2.6 Ethical Industry Participation

Members must contribute to the beauty industry in a manner consistent with lawful practice, professional ethics, fair competition and the goal of strengthening the profession.

3. Scope

This Code of Ethics applies to:

- conduct in professional practice;
- conduct in educational activities;
- conduct in business and public representation;
- participation in IBPA events, committees, competitions, programs, meetings and communications;
- conduct on websites, social media, digital platforms, promotional materials and public profiles where the member's professional status or membership in the Association is stated;
- communications with the Association, its leadership, members, applicants, partners, sponsors and the public.

Members may be held accountable under this Code for conduct occurring both within and outside the Association's formal activities if such conduct materially affects:

- the reputation of the Association;
- the integrity of membership;
- the safety or dignity of others;
- trust within the professional community.

4. Honest Professional Representation

4.1 Truthfulness about Qualifications and Competencies

Members must accurately represent their qualifications, training, certificates, licenses, experience, awards, publications, judging roles, speaking roles, teaching roles, memberships and other professional achievements.

4.2 Prohibition of False or Misleading Statements

Members must not:

- falsely claim to hold licenses, certificates, titles or qualifications they do not hold;
- misrepresent the nature or level of their education or training;
- exaggerate results, outcomes or the level of their expertise in a misleading way;
- make false or deceptive claims about awards, recognition, rankings or status with the Association;
- falsely imply endorsement, accreditation, legal authorization or government approval where none exists.

4.3 Accurate Use of Membership in the Association

Members may describe themselves as IBPA members only if their membership is active and in good standing.

Members must not:

- imply that membership in the Association is a government license;
- state or imply that IBPA guarantees a legal right to practice;
- misrepresent membership as a state-issued certificate or government approval;
- continue to use IBPA member status after membership has expired, been suspended or been terminated.

5. Professional Conduct toward Clients

5.1 Respectful Treatment

Members must treat clients with respect, professionalism, courtesy and appropriate personal and professional boundaries.

5.2 Clear Communication

Members must communicate honestly and clearly about:

- the nature of the services provided;
- the expected results;
- the limitations of the services;
- booking, prices and terms of service, where applicable;
- appropriate aftercare instructions, expectations and professional recommendations.

5.3 Prohibition of Exploitation

Members must not exploit clients emotionally, financially, professionally or otherwise.

5.4 Client Dignity and Safety

Members must not engage in conduct that humiliates, pressures, intimidates, coerces or offends the dignity of clients.

5.5 Lawful and Responsible Practice

Members must work only within the scope of their training, competence and, where applicable, the licensing requirements of the relevant jurisdiction.

6. Professional Conduct toward Colleagues and the Professional Community

6.1 Respectful Professional Relationships

Members must maintain respectful and professional relationships with other beauty industry professionals, educators, students, judges, suppliers, partners, employees and participants of the Association.

6.2 Prohibition of Defamation and Malicious Conduct

Members must not knowingly spread false, malicious, defamatory or deliberately harmful statements about another person or business.

6.3 Fair Competition

Members must compete honestly and ethically and must not engage in unfair business practices aimed at unlawfully or unfairly harming the reputation or business interests of others.

6.4 Professional Disagreement

Differences of opinion, criticism and professional disagreements must be expressed respectfully, responsibly and on the basis of facts.

7. Ethical Conduct in Training, Mentoring and Teaching

This section applies in particular to members of the Trainer / Educator category, schools, academies, mentors and members engaged in teaching or training.

7.1 Accuracy in Education

Members who teach must provide information in good faith and within the limits of their professional knowledge and experience.

7.2 Prohibition of False Promises

Educators must not give misleading guarantees regarding:

- student success;
- income levels;
- licensing outcomes;
- equivalence of certificates;
- employment;
- competition results.

7.3 Honest Program Representation

Educators must accurately represent:

- course scope;
- course duration;
- content;
- requirements;
- documents issued;
- whether any certificate is internal, private or non-governmental.

7.4 Respect for Students

Educators and mentors must treat students with respect and must not abuse their authority, manipulate students or mislead them about their level of readiness, certification, status or professional opportunities.

8. Ethical Conduct in Business and Leadership

This section applies in particular to members of the Business Owner and Brand / Company categories, representatives of organizations and members in leadership roles.

8.1 Responsible Business Practice

Members must conduct their business affairs honestly, responsibly and in accordance with professional ethics.

8.2 Transparent Representation

Business and brand members must accurately represent their:

- products;
- services;
- affiliations;
- brand claims;
- partnerships;
- qualifications;
- certificates;
- professional endorsements.

8.3 Prohibition of Abuse of Influence

Members must not abuse their professional authority, relationship with the Association or industry status for deceptive, coercive, exploitative or other improper purposes.

8.4 Responsibility to the Team and Community

Business owners and leaders are encouraged to build a professional environment that supports lawful practice, respect, ethics, accountability and growth.

9. Confidentiality and Privacy

9.1 Client Confidentiality

Members must respect the confidentiality of client information unless its disclosure is:

- required by law;
- authorized by the client;
- reasonably necessary for legitimate legal or safety reasons.

9.2 Professional Discretion

Members must exercise discretion when discussing private client matters, internal affairs of the Association, confidential review procedures, complaints or confidential business information.

9.3 Member and Applicant Information

Members involved in the work of the Board, committees, review procedures, standards, disciplinary or administrative functions must keep confidential any non-public information obtained in connection with their role.

10. Respectful Conduct and Prohibition of Harassment

10.1 Respectful Conduct

Members must behave respectfully in all Association-related settings, including events, digital platforms, meetings, committees and communications.

10.2 Prohibited Conduct

The following conduct is incompatible with this Code and may result in disciplinary action:

- harassment;
- intimidation;

- bullying;
- threats;
- abusive conduct;
- demeaning or degrading treatment;
- discriminatory conduct;
- retaliation against an applicant, witness, member of the Membership Review Board, committee participant or person who has reported a violation.

10.3 Inclusiveness and Professional Respect

Members are expected to support a culture of respect and professional dignity within a diverse professional community.

11. Social Media, Public Statements and Reputation

11.1 Public Conduct

Members who refer to IBPA, their membership, participation in the Association, awards or Association-related activities in public statements, on websites, in interviews or on social media must do so responsibly and truthfully.

11.2 Prohibition of Misleading References to the Association

Members must not imply that:

- IBPA endorses every personal opinion they express;
- IBPA approves their legal right to practice;
- IBPA guarantees their professional competence beyond the mere fact of membership;
- IBPA has granted them authority that has not actually been granted.

11.3 Protection of Reputation

Members must avoid conduct that materially harms the reputation, mission, credibility or integrity of the Association.

12. Compliance with Law and Professional Requirements

12.1 Compliance with the Law

Members are expected to comply with applicable laws, regulations, licensing requirements and professional obligations relevant to their jurisdiction and activities.

12.2 Prohibition on Representing the Association as a Government Body

Members must not represent IBPA as a government licensing body, regulatory agency or legal certification authority.

12.3 Informational Role of the Association

Members must understand that IBPA may provide educational and professional guidance, but such guidance does not replace their own compliance with legal, licensing or regulatory obligations.

13. Ethical Participation in Association Programs, Events, Competitions and Awards

13.1 Compliance with Rules

Members taking part in events, programs, competitions, awards, committees, publications or speaking engagements must comply with all applicable rules, guidelines and procedures of the Association.

13.2 Good-Faith Participation

Members must not seek an unfair advantage in competitions, award programs, judging or Association opportunities through deception, improper influence or dishonest conduct.

13.3 Cooperation with Procedures

Members must cooperate in good faith with:

- review procedures;
- standards inquiries;
- membership inquiries;
- complaint procedures;
- disciplinary matters;
- requests for documents reasonably related to the Association's processes.

14. Conflict of Interest and Ethical Decision-Making

Members serving as directors, officers, committee members, judges, members of the Membership Review Board or in other positions of responsibility must act in the best interests of the Association and disclose actual, potential or perceived conflicts of interest in accordance with IBPA's governing documents and Conflict of Interest Policy.

Such persons must not use their role to improperly benefit themselves, their business, family members, affiliates or other persons with whom they have a conflicting interest.

15. Obligations of Members in Good Standing

To maintain good standing, members are expected to:

- comply with this Code of Ethics;
- comply with the Professional Standards, the Bylaws, the Association's policies and applicable procedures;
- provide accurate information to the Association;
- maintain professional integrity in their conduct and self-representation;
- respond in good faith to the Association's lawful communications concerning membership status, standards or reviews;
- refrain from conduct that materially harms the Association;
- update current membership information when required.

16. Reporting Ethical Violations

16.1 Right to Report

A member, applicant, officer, director, committee member, partner or other relevant person may report a suspected violation of this Code of Ethics to the Association.

16.2 Method of Submission

Ethical concerns may be submitted in writing to the Association through the established submission procedure, by email to support@ibpassociations.org or through another official channel established by the Association.

16.3 Good-Faith Reports

Reports must be made in good faith and based on information reasonably believed to be accurate.

16.4 No Retaliation

Retaliation against any person who reports a violation in good faith, takes part in an inquiry or provides information in connection with an ethics review is prohibited.

17. Review and Enforcement

17.1 Reviewing Body

Alleged violations of this Code may be reviewed by the appropriate body of the Association, which may be:

- the Standards & Ethics Committee;
- the Membership Review Board;
- the Board of Directors;
- or another body authorized by the Association's governing documents.

17.2 Fair Process

Before taking significant disciplinary action, the Association should generally give the member concerned notice of the issue and a reasonable opportunity to respond, except where immediate interim measures are necessary to protect the Association or others.

17.3 Possible Measures

If a violation is established, the Association may take one or more measures in accordance with its governing documents and applicable policies, including:

- educational guidance;
- a warning;
- a requirement to take corrective action;
- temporary restriction of certain privileges;
- denial of an application;
- non-renewal;
- suspension of membership;
- termination of membership;
- removal from a committee, judging role or other Association-related role.

Decisions on measures may be appealed in accordance with Article 14 of the Bylaws.

18. No Automatic Right to Membership or Position

Compliance with this Code does not guarantee approval of membership, appointment to a leadership position, committee placement, speaking opportunities, awards or other recognition from the Association.

Non-compliance with this Code may be taken into account in:

- membership reviews;
- membership renewals;
- committee appointments;
- consideration of speakers or authors;
- award and recognition processes;
- disciplinary matters.

19. Relationship to Other Governing Documents

This Code of Ethics must be read together with the Association's governing documents, including, without limitation:

- the Bylaws;
- the Professional Standards;
- the Membership Policy;
- the Membership Application Review Procedure and the Membership Review Policy;
- the Membership Cancellation and Termination Policy;
- the Conflict of Interest Policy;
- the Committee Charters;
- other duly adopted policies.

In the event of a direct conflict between this Code and the Bylaws, the Bylaws prevail unless otherwise required by law or expressly stated in a later-adopted governing document.

20. Amendments

This Code of Ethics may be amended by the Board of Directors in accordance with the procedures established by the Association's governing documents.

Amendments take effect on the date specified in the approving resolution unless otherwise stated.

21. Acknowledgment

All members may be required to confirm that they have read, understood and agreed to comply with this Code of Ethics as a condition of applying, approval, renewal, participation in certain Association activities or maintaining good standing.

22. Official Language

The official version of this Code of Ethics is maintained in English. Any translation is provided for convenience only. In the event of any discrepancy, the English version prevails.